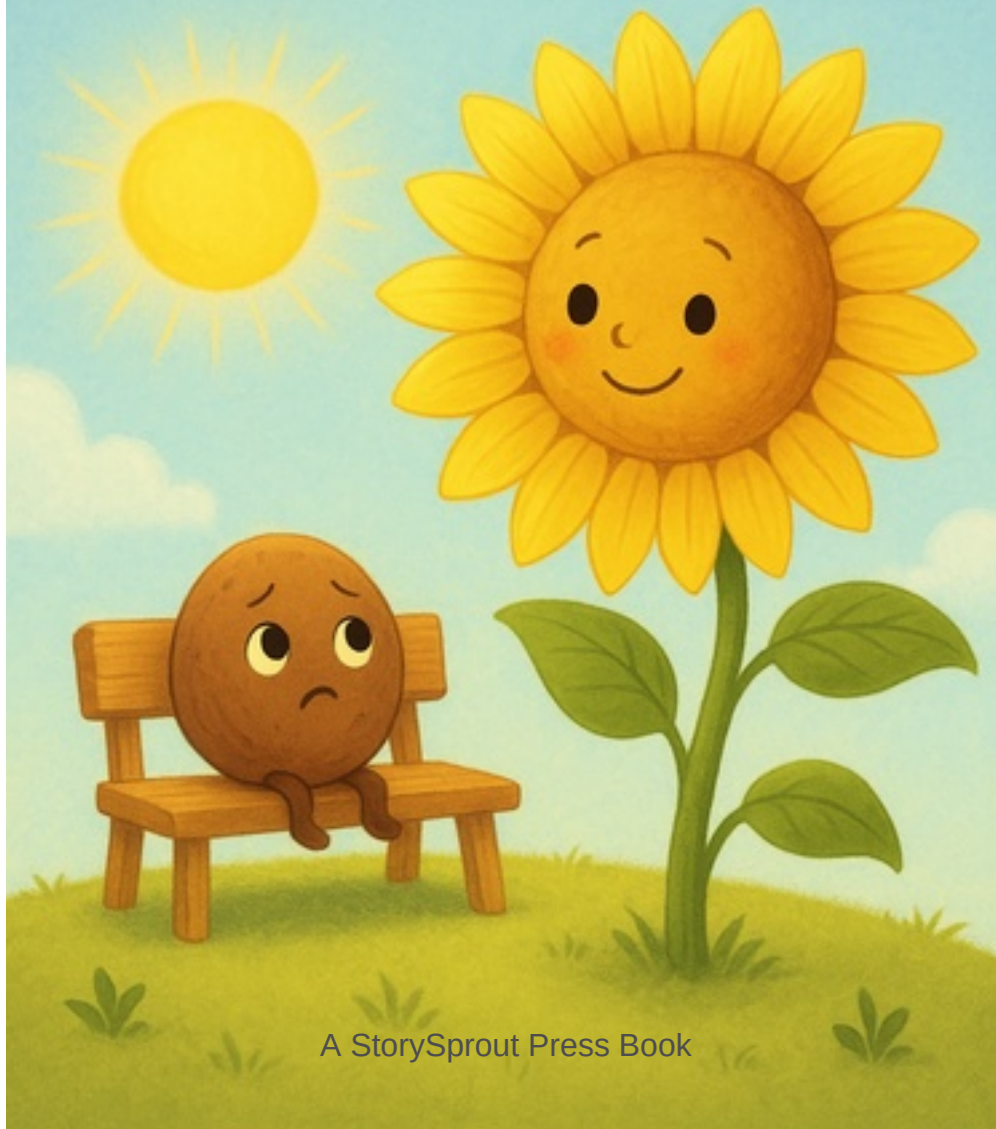


THE BRAVE LITTLE SEED

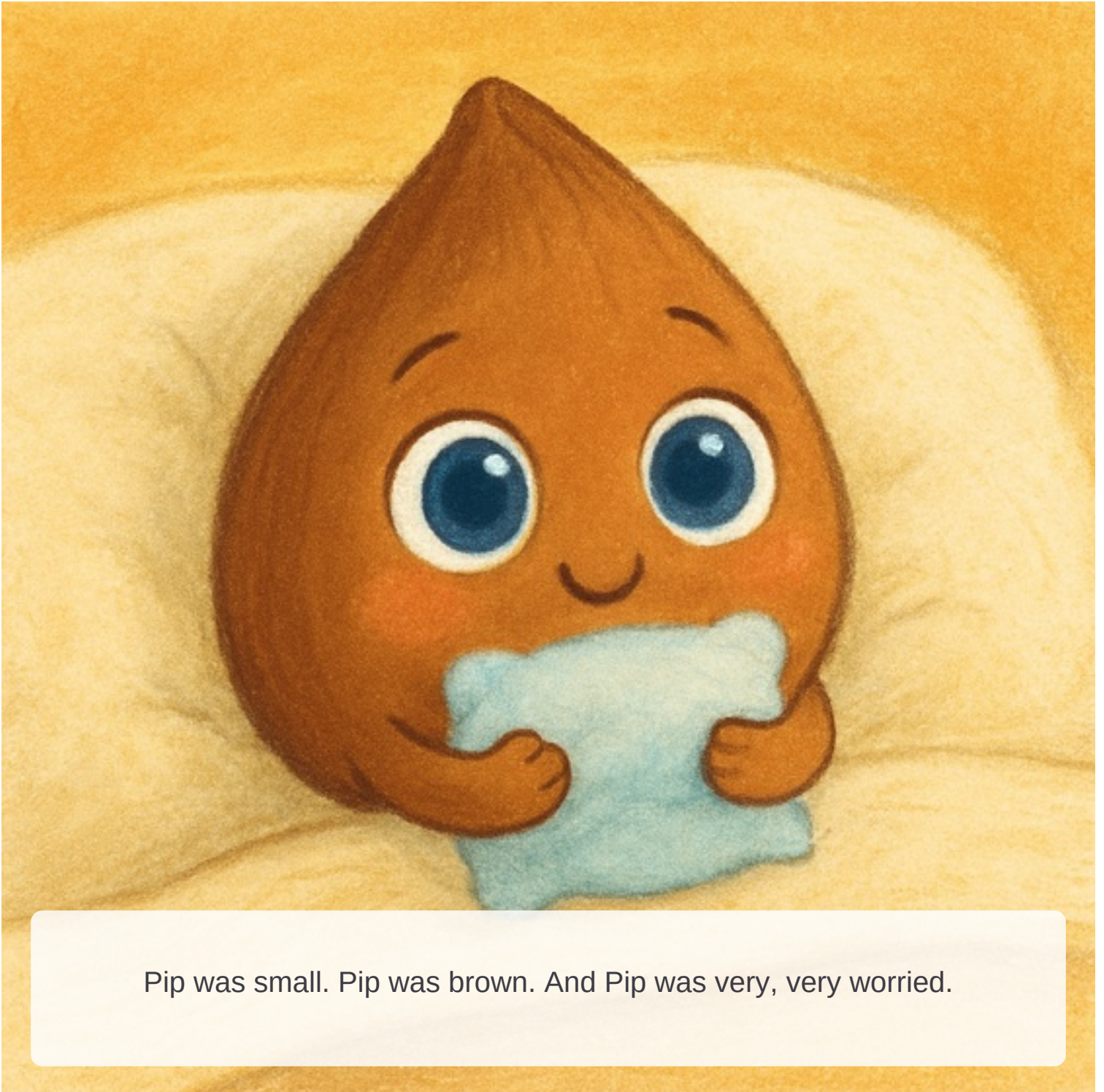




THE BRAVE LITTLE SEED



Once there was a tiny seed named Pip. Pip lived in a cozy paper packet with all his friends.



Pip was small. Pip was brown. And Pip was very, very worried.



"It's time to grow!" the farmer said. He picked up Pip with his big, gentle hand.



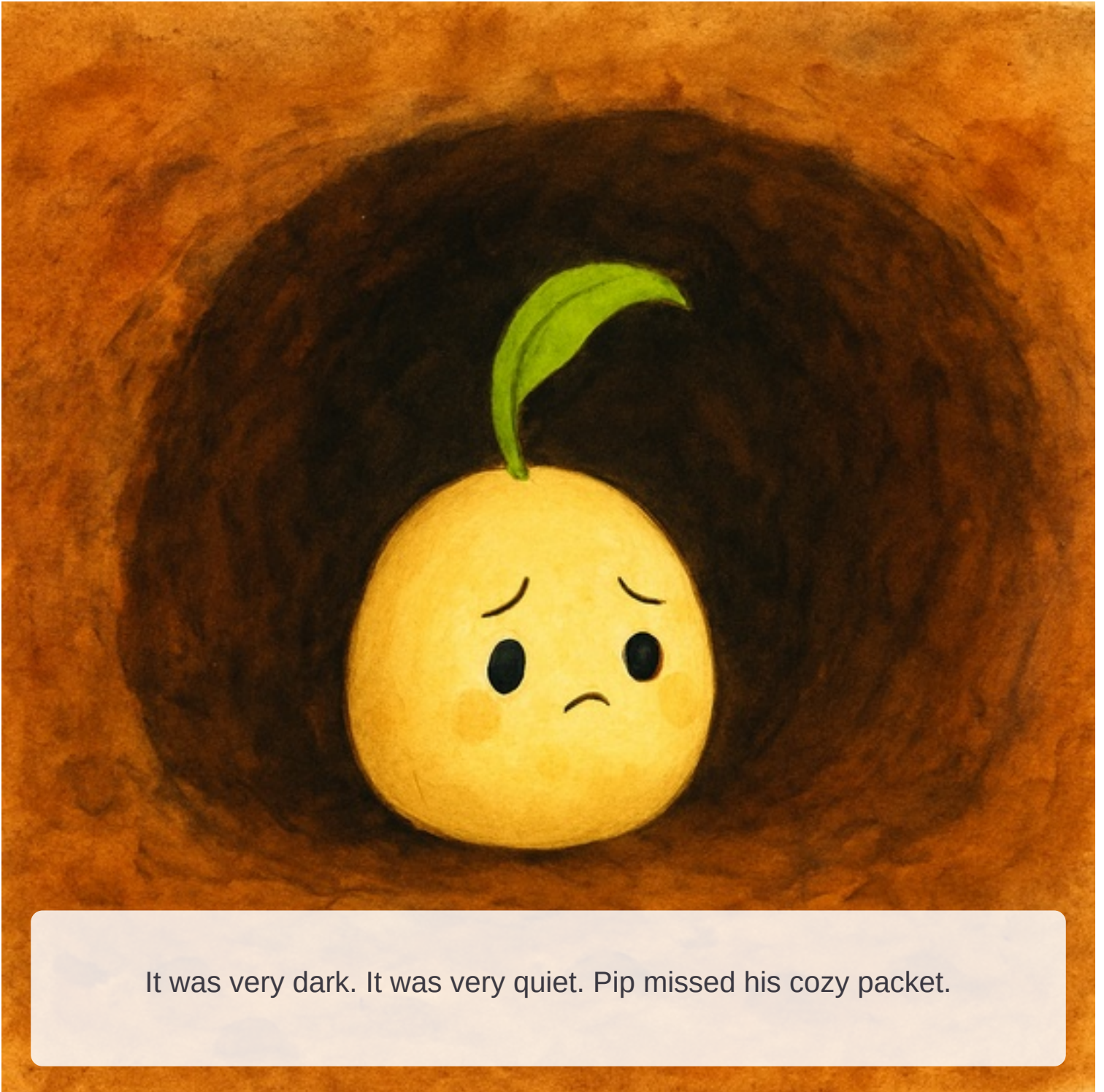
"Wait!" Pip cried. "The world is too big! I'm just a little seed!"



"Don't be afraid, little one," a soft voice whispered. It was Mama Sunflower, leaning down from the sky.



The farmer tucked Pip into a little hole in the soft, brown earth.



It was very dark. It was very quiet. Pip missed his cozy packet.



Wiggle, waggle, wiggle! Suddenly, a friendly face popped through the dirt.
It was Wiggly Worm.



"Don't worry, Pip!" Wiggly said. "The soil isn't scary. It's just a cozy blanket to help you grow."



Pip started to feel a little better. But he still felt very small and very stuck.



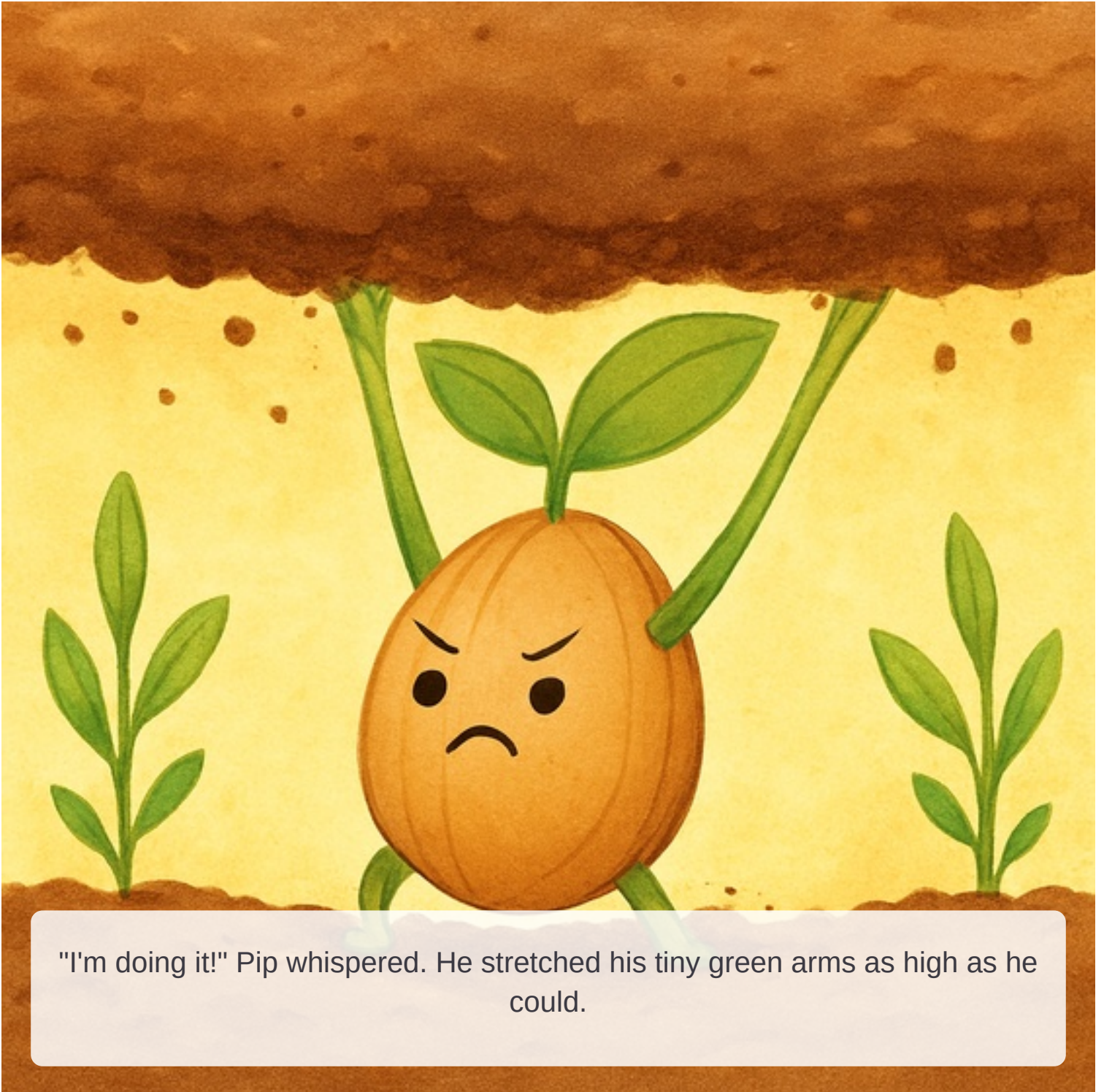
Then, a happy song filled the air. *Plink! Plank! Plunk!* Raindrop Rita landed right on Pip's head.



"Drink up, Pip!" Rita sang. "The rain brings strength! The rain brings magic!"



Pip felt a strange tickle in his tummy. He felt warmer. He felt stronger.





Pop! Pip's head poked through the ground. The world was bright and beautiful!



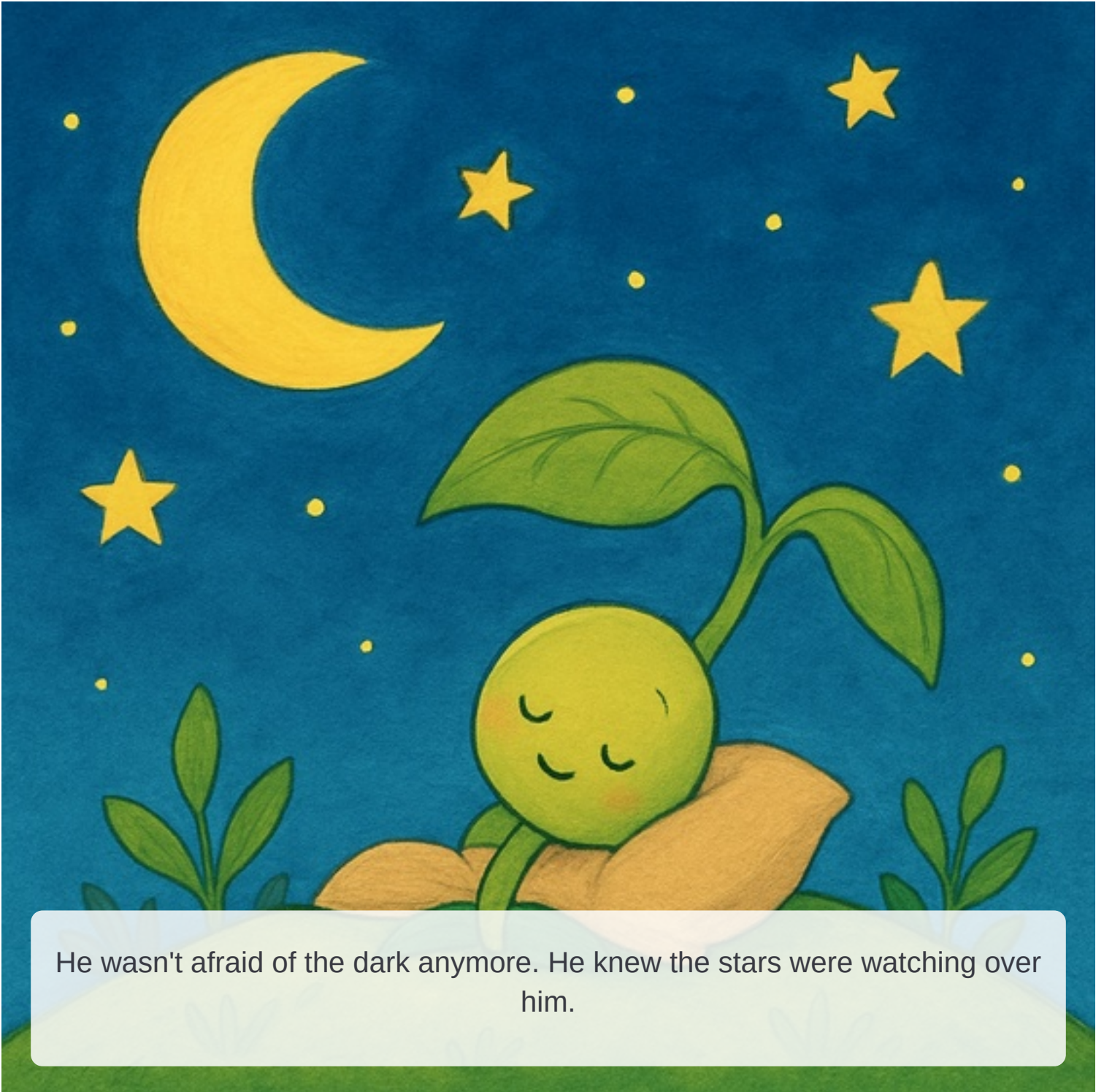
"You did it, Pip!" Mama Sunflower cheered. The sun felt warm and kind on his new green leaves.



Every day, the sun shone and the rain sang. And every day, Pip grew a little bit taller.



Pip wasn't afraid of the wind anymore. He loved to dance with the breeze.



He wasn't afraid of the dark anymore. He knew the stars were watching over him.



Soon, Pip had a big, round head of his own. It was filled with tiny, golden buds.



One morning, *burst!* Pip opened up. He was a bright, beautiful sunflower!



"Growing is a big adventure," Pip said to a tiny seed on the ground. "And you are going to be so brave!"

The Brave Little Seed



Pip stood tall and proud in the garden. He was the bravest little seed of all.

THE BRAVE LITTLE SEED



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